Environmental Psychology



Lecture one

Introduction of Environmental Psychology

- Why Environmental Psychology?
- Environmental Psychology

  - concept

  - purpose

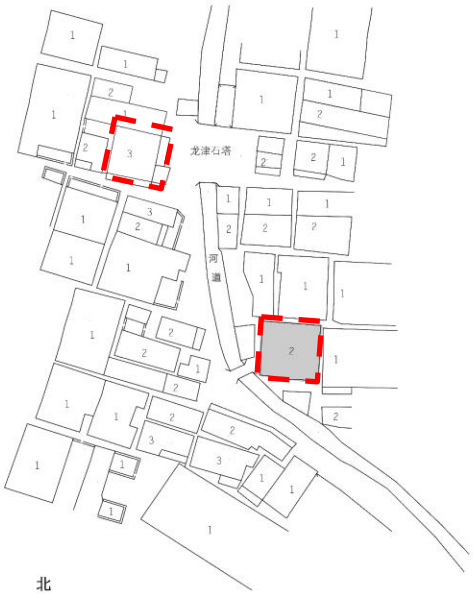
  - history

Part One

- What is Environmental Psychology?
- What does Environmental Psychology concern?

城中住宅设计

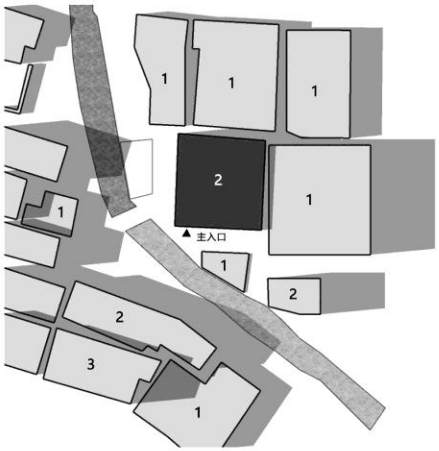
——场地与功能



区域地图1：400



Street + Buildings + River



总平面图1：200



室外透视拼贴图

Programming

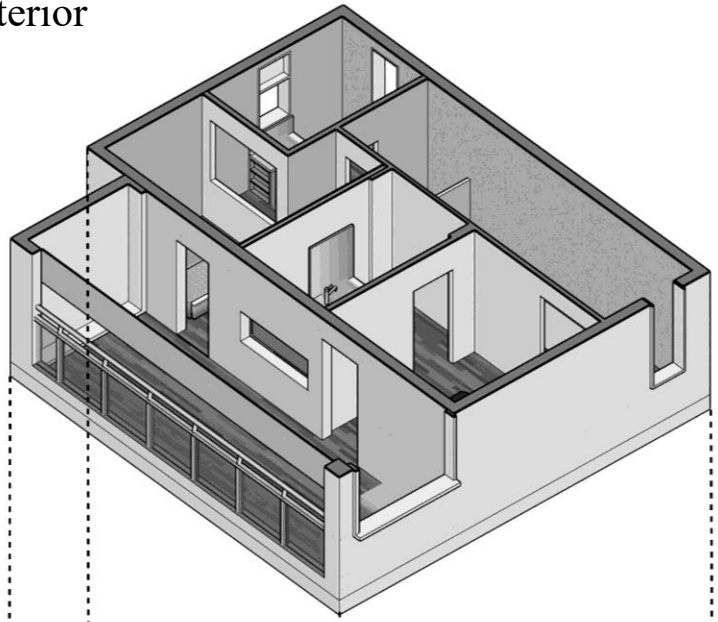
Floors	2层
Areas	180平方米
FAR	：1.8
Family members	父母+2孩

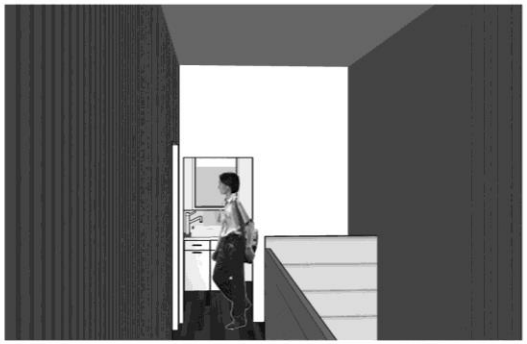
What's the transaction from pristine land to built environment?

Building Processes: Design Interior



Balcony

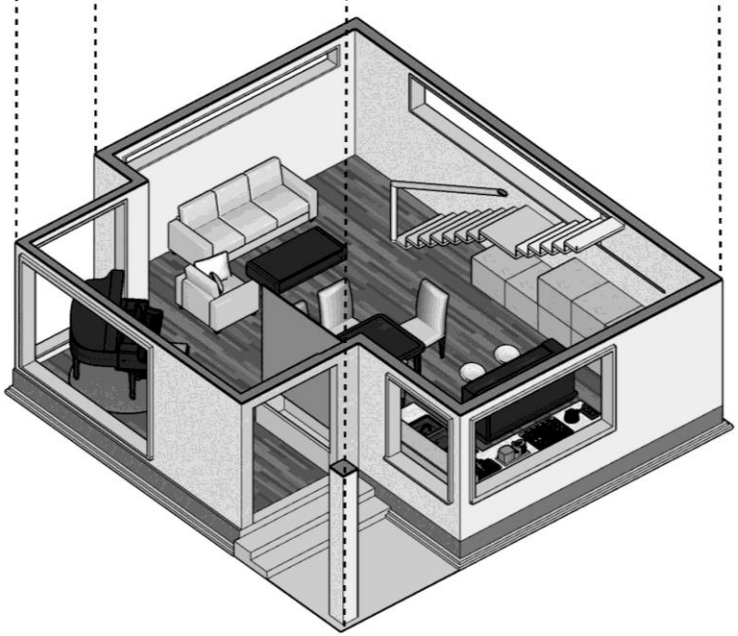




Corridor



Entrance





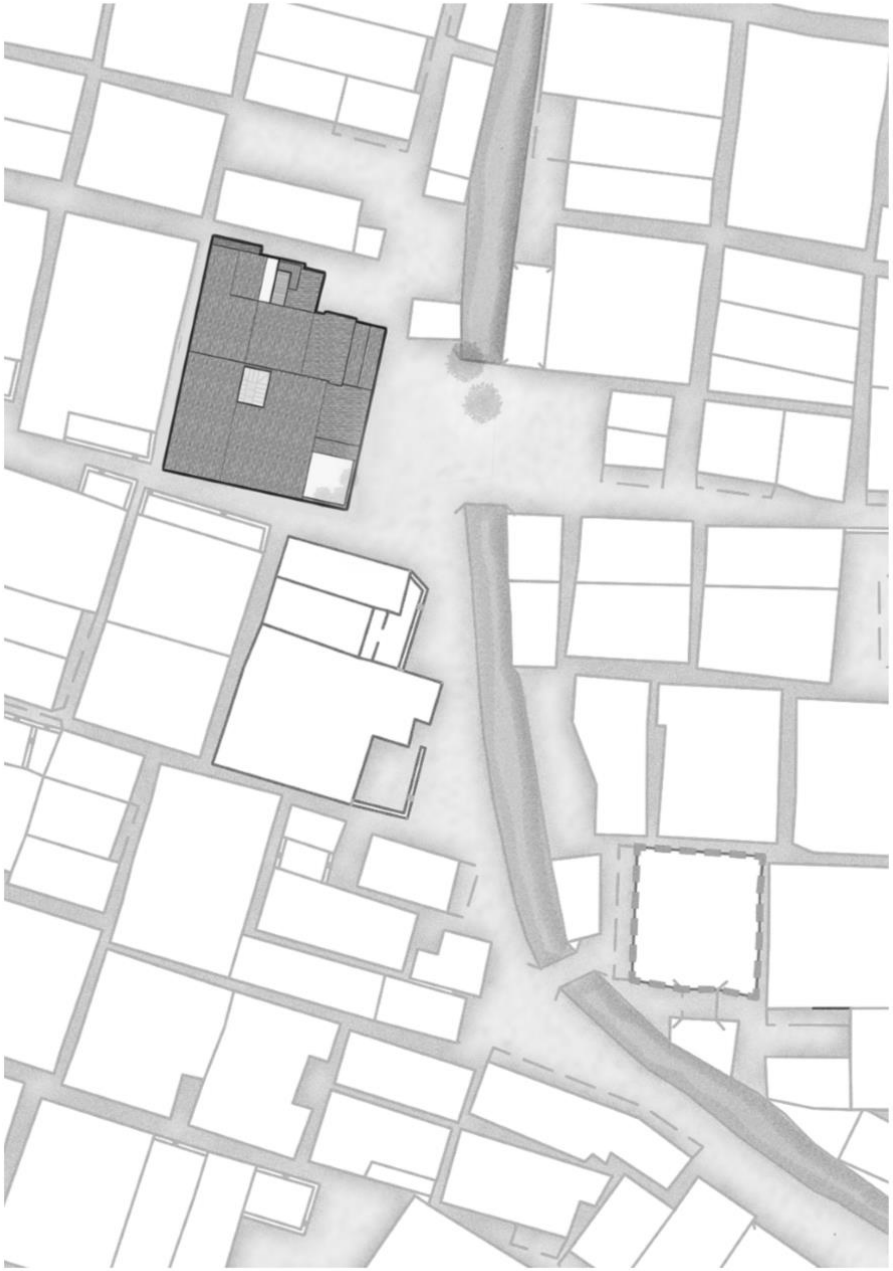
Kitchen

Building Processes: Outside Looking





Changes: Site plan design



总平面图 1:200



人口构成：父母＋祖父母＋女儿
建筑面积：175m²
层数：2层
容积率：1.88







场地调研照片

Technical drawings



1-1 剖面图 1:50



2-2 剖面图 1:50



南立面 1:50



东立面 1:50

Environmental Psychology

- **Environmental Psychology is the study of transactions between individuals and their physical settings.**

- **Transactions:**

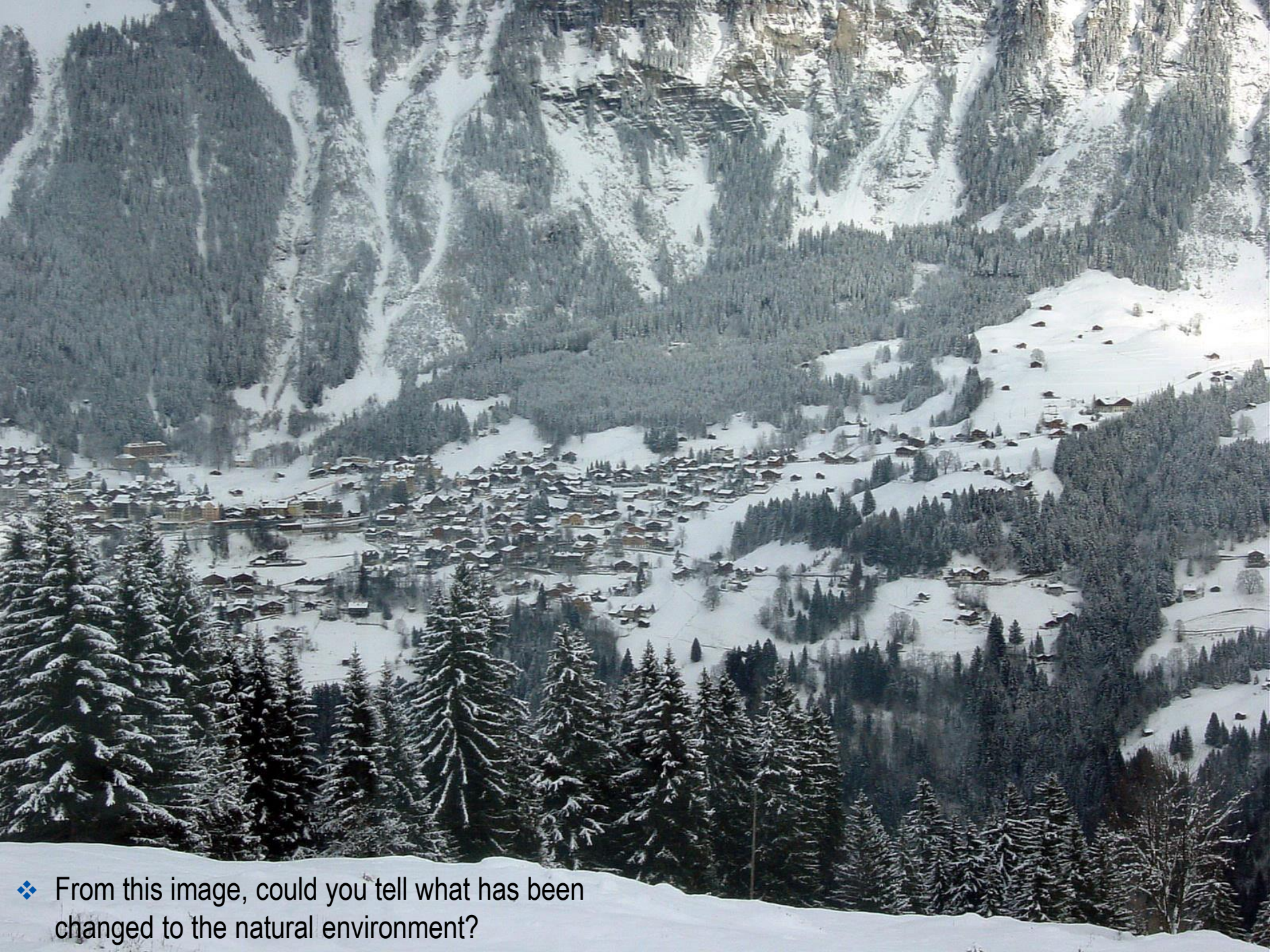
(1) Individuals behavior and experiences are limited and changed by the environment.

(2) Individuals change the environment.

- **Environmental Psychology** includes research and practice aimed at making buildings more humane and improving our relationship with the natural environment.

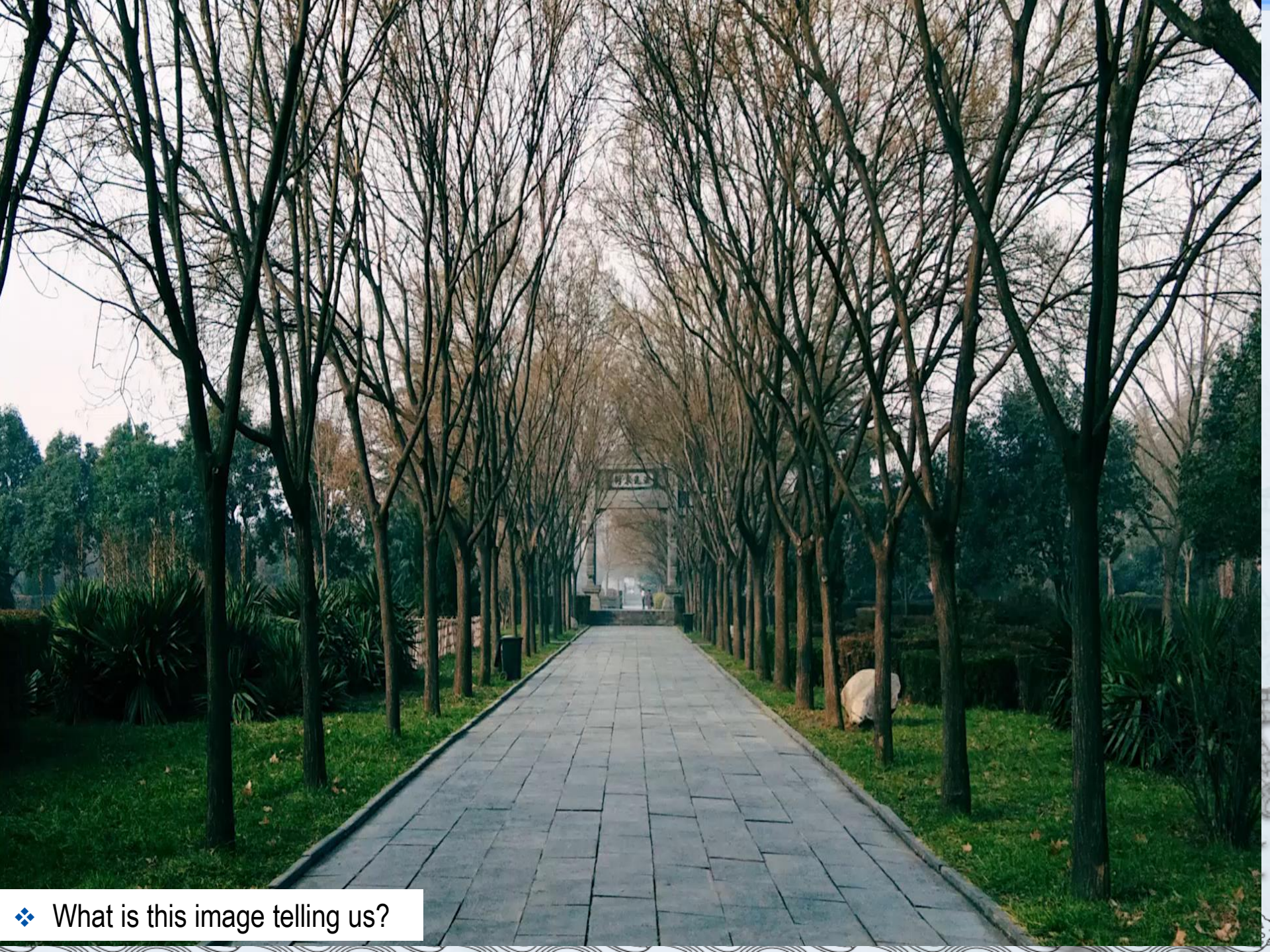
Why Environmental Psychology: - considering

- The enormous investment society makes in the construction and maintenance of the physical environment (including buildings, parks, streets, the atmosphere, bodies of water, sounds etc.)
- The enormous cost of misusing nature and natural resources.
- The long delay before person-environment relations received adequate attention seems almost tragic.



- From this image, could you tell what has been changed to the natural environment?


Pilgrimheim



- What is this image telling us?

- You may not be able to do what you want to do if the environment does not support you.

- You have motivation to make a change to the environment





- Think about what humans might do to this pristine natural environment – hike, hunt, or even construct buildings and infrastructure?

- We are responsible to the situation where we are or where we will go.
- The situation is more serious than we realized.
- **Architectures play a role and architects are in charged**

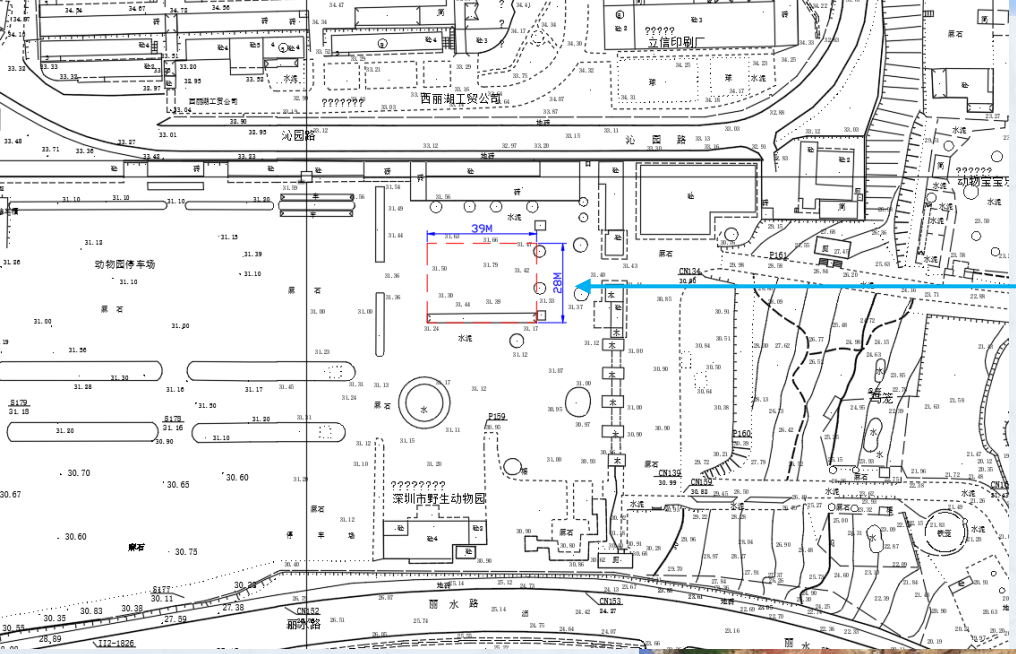








Building a visit center for the Shenzhen Safari Park



Why here???

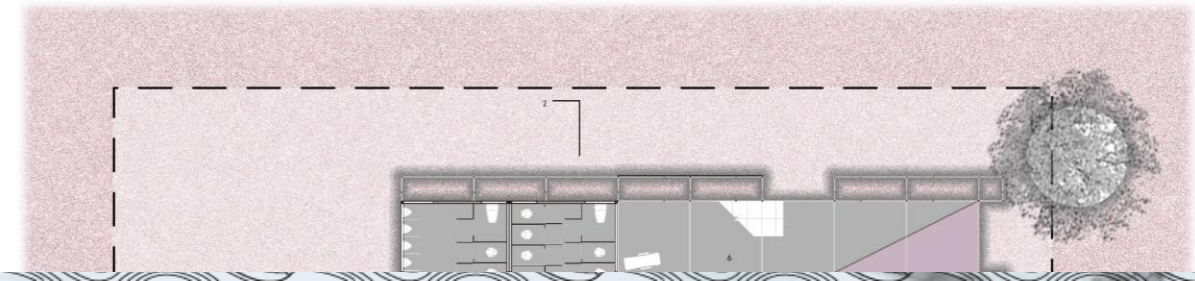
Physical characteristics of the surroundings

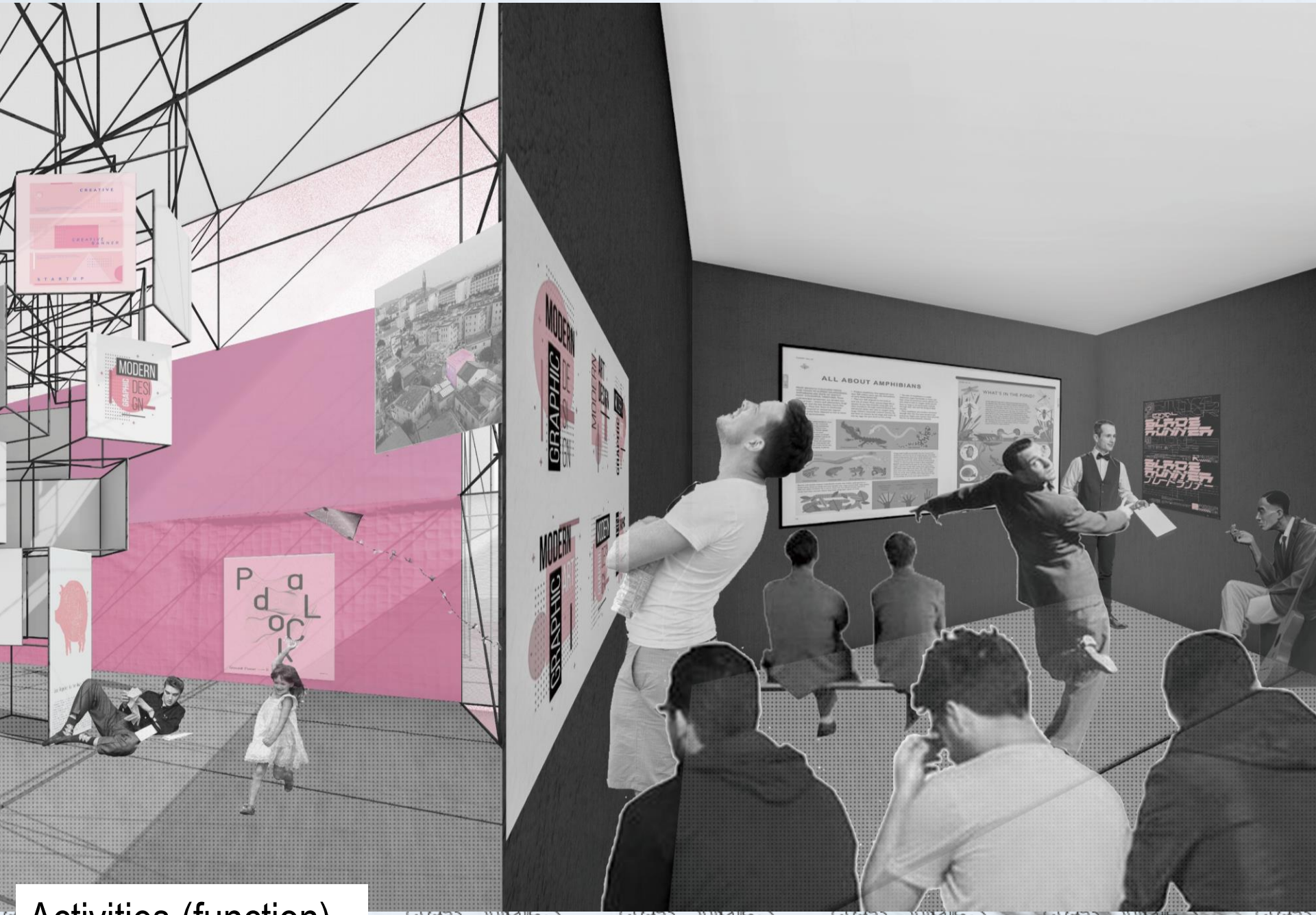




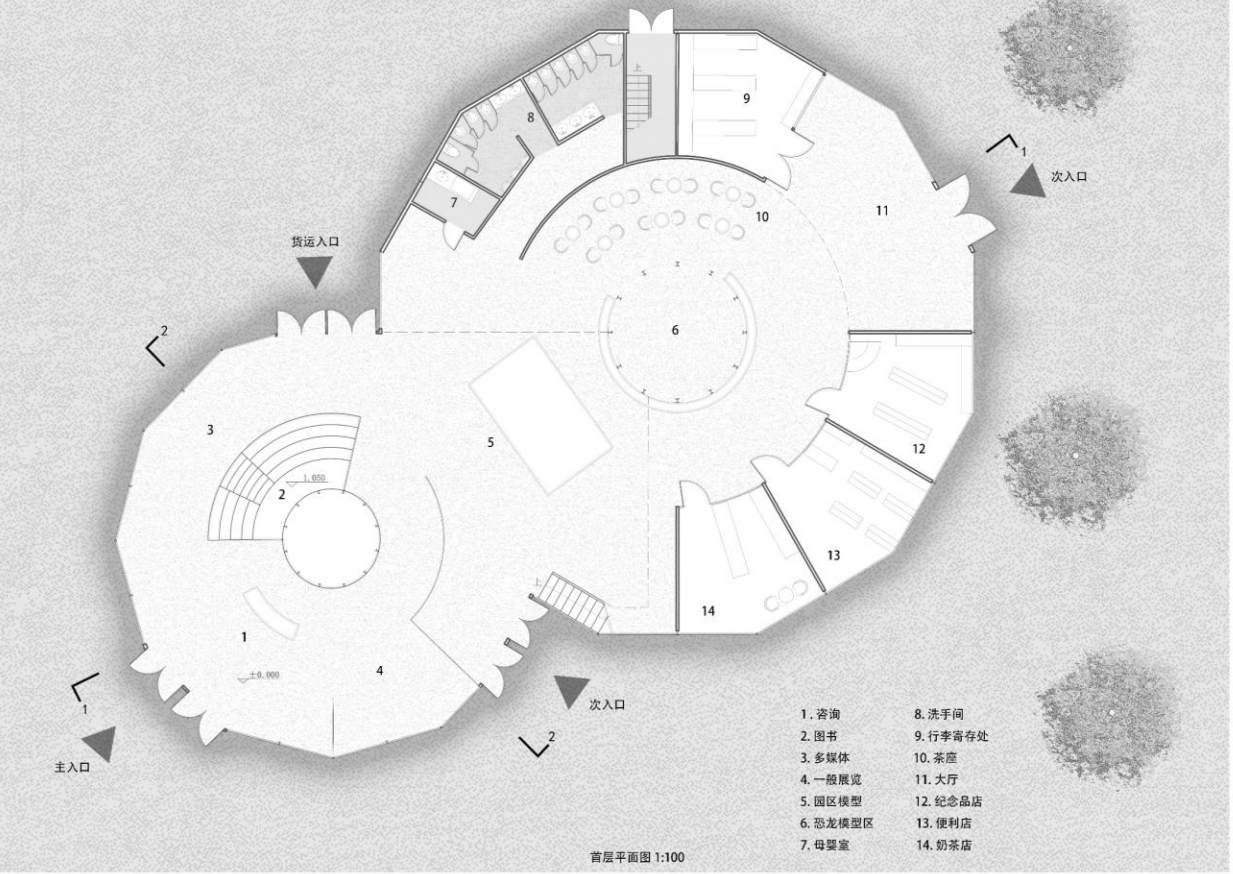
Site plan





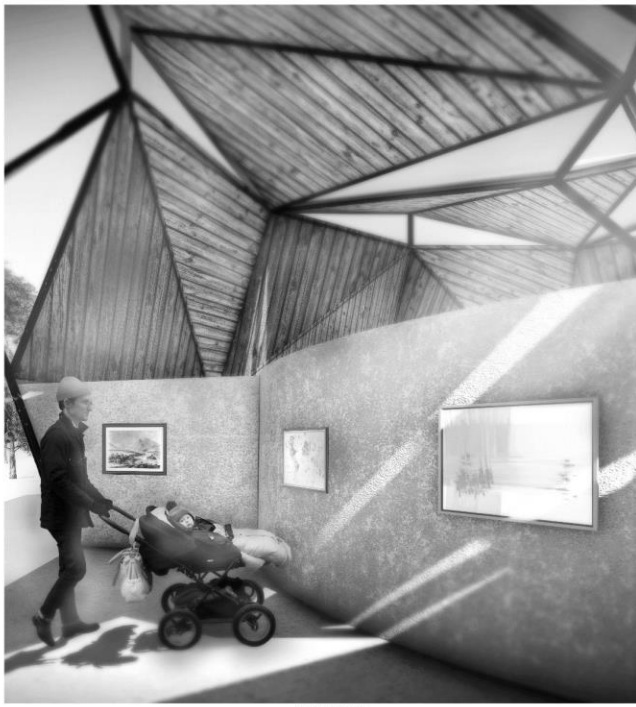


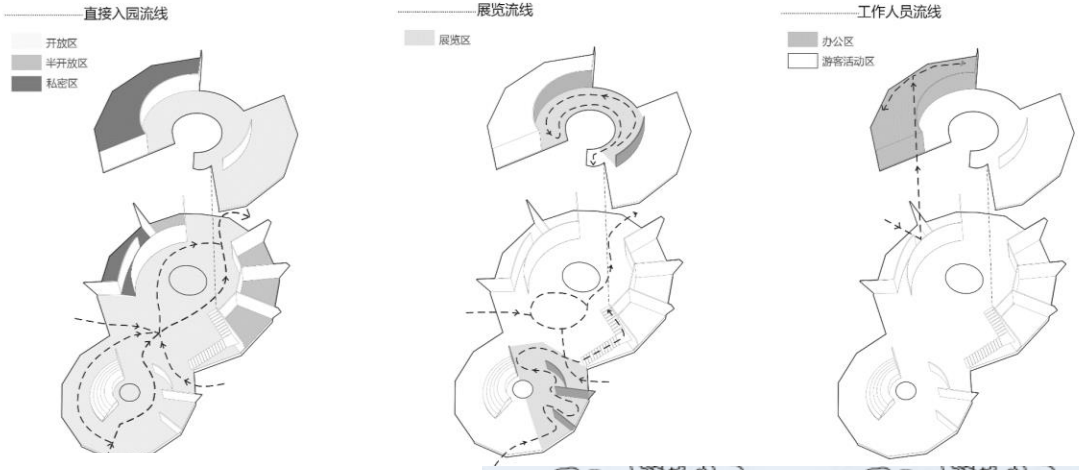
Activities (function)



首层平面图 1:100


入口展墙视角





Space for containing.....

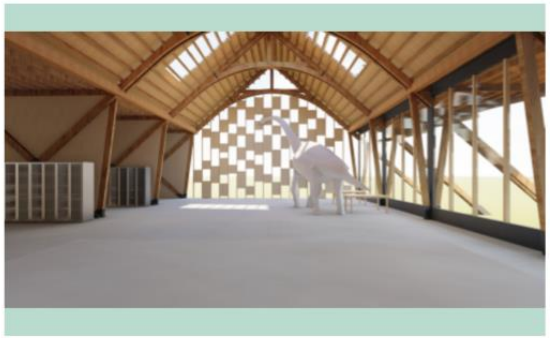
游客中心：结构与构造

郑灿源 1906110113 指导老师：李博、袁照

项目地点：深圳市南山区深圳野生动物园　　建筑基底面积：596.00m²

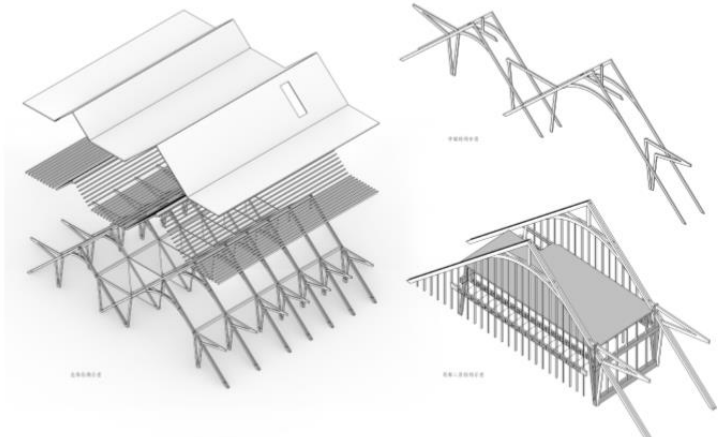
建筑总面积：741.65m²　　容积率：1.199

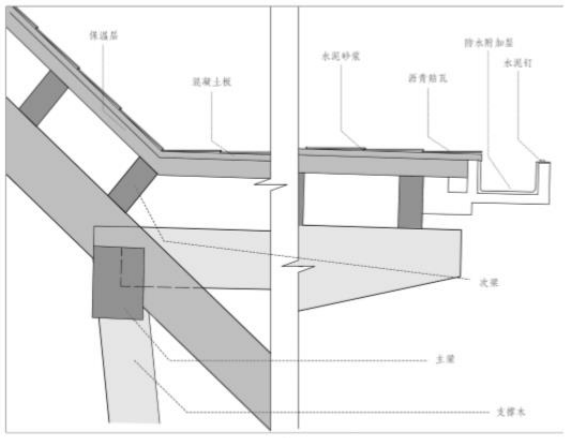












屋顶构造图

Why looks like this? (appearance)

Part Two

- History of Environmental Psychology
- Concept of Environmental Psychology

History of Environmental Psychology

- The field of environmental psychology may be traced far back into **the history of psychology.**
- As a recognized field, environmental psychology is only about 60 years old, but some works can be tracked back to decades ago. In the early days of psychology, most researchers concentrated heavily on processes within persons rather than person-environment transactions.
- The empirical roots of environmental psychology began much earlier. Before 1920, psychologists had studied the effect of noise and heat on work performance.
- Environmental psychology has been recognized as a field of psychology since the late 1960s and is therefore *a relatively 'new' field in psychology*.

History of Environmental Psychology

- **Egon Brunswik** (1903-1955) originally concentrated on the process of perception but his idea having been extended far beyond that. In calling for more detailed analysis of the way physical environment factors affect behavior, **he *was probably the first to use the term environmental psychology***.

- **Kurt Lewin** (1890-1947). His field theory was one of the first to give active consideration to the molar physical environment. His idea of action research was perhaps the first major push in psychology toward linking scientific research with real social change.
  - **Psychological ecology** The physical environment could affect people without their knowing.

    For example- the hum of a fluorescent light fixture might affect an office worker's satisfaction with work or productivity even though the office worker is unaware of the hum.

- **Neither Brunswik nor Lewin actually performed studies that today would be called environmental psychology.**

History of Environmental Psychology

- **Lewin** has had a strong influence in psychology. He inspired many students who, in turn, profoundly shaped the direction of social science. His students interpreted his ideas to mean that *the social environment* and *the perceived environment* were crucial. Thus, environmental psychology was one edge of Lewin's legacy.

- **Lewin's students** did take the physical environment more seriously and pursued psychological ecology, later changing the term to ecological psychology.

- **Roger Barker** and **Herbert Wright** began a large-scale research project in 1947 that studied behavior settings, small ecological units enclosing everyday human behavior. Behavior settings include both social rules and the physical-spatial aspects of our daily lives.

- It seems at first to be indistinguishable from the main core of psychology since most psychologist examine the relations between environmental stimuli and human responses.

- What sets environmental psychology apart from psychology:
  - It considers the person and setting to be a holistic entity
  - It recognizes that individuals actively cope with and shape settings, rather than passively absorb environmental forces.

History of Environmental Psychology

- Since the late 1960s, thousands of studies have dealt with the major topics of how and why humans act and feel in their natural settings, the intricacies of person-environment transactions, and the recognition of environmental problems.

- A study of where students sat in classrooms in relation to the grades they earned was published.

- The same photos of people were rated more positively when the ratings were done in a beautiful room than when they were done in an average or ugly room, even though the aesthetics of the room was never mentioned to the raters.

- The specific term “environmental psychology” actually came out of an interest in the relationship between the design of **psychiatric hospital wards** and evidence of therapeutic progress (changing wall color, rearranging furniture, increasing or decreasing access to private space help or hinder treatment)

History of Environmental Psychology

- Considering the enormous investments, we makes in the construction and maintenance of the physical environment (including buildings, parks, streets, the atmosphere and bodies of water) and the cost of misusing nature and natural resources, the long delay before person-environment relations received adequate attention seems almost tragic.

- **Hellpach** was one of the first scholars who introduced the term 'environmental psychology' in the first half of the 20th century. He studied the impact of different environmental stimuli, such as colour and form, the sun and the moon and extreme environments, on human activities.

  He also studied urban phenomena, such as crowding and overstimulation, and distinguished different types of environments (e.g. natural, social and historical-cultural environments).

End of the First Lecture

Thanks for attention

Any questions? (leilayu@hit.edu.cn)